# Design elements & principles

National 5 · Design & DTP · Worksheet

GRAPHICS WITH MR KELLY

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

**By the end of this worksheet I can…**

- ☐ explain line, colour, alignment, contrast, dominance, depth and unity, referring to specific items
- ☐ name the type of alignment between items

## I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

*A poster for a smartwatch has a large white "65%" over a black background and a "BUY NOW" button in the same white.*

**1 Explain how two design elements or principles have been used to create visual impact.** (2 marks)

**Full-mark answer** each ✓ is one mark

The white "65%" contrasts strongly with the black background, so it stands out ✓. It is also the largest element on the poster, so it dominates and is the first thing the viewer reads ✓.

**Why marks are not awarded**

*"Contrast and dominance have been used to make it stand out."*

0 marks: no items in the poster are referred to.

## WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

*A web page has a heading, a block of body text and three images down the right-hand side.*

**2 Describe two examples of alignment used in the layout.** (2 marks)

**Sentence starters**

One … is …, which means …

Another … is …, so …

**Word bank**

images · captions · aligned · bottom · vertically · centrally · heading

Tip: 2 marks = 2 separate, developed points.

**YOU DO** **On your own** No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

### 3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

**a)** Which answer would score for alignment?
☐ The items are aligned ☐ The heading and body text are left aligned ☐ Alignment makes it neat ☐ It is balanced

**b)** Repeating the same font and colour across a layout creates...
☐ Contrast ☐ Unity ☐ Depth ☐ Dominance

**c)** The largest, brightest item that is seen first shows...
☐ Unity ☐ Dominance ☐ White space ☐ Alignment

**d)** A drop shadow behind an image mainly creates...
☐ Depth ☐ Rhythm ☐ Unity ☐ Alignment

### 4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1. **Dominance** | ____ | **A** The item that stands out most and is seen first. |
| 2. **Contrast** | ____ | **B** Items look like they belong together: repeated colour, font, shape. |
| 3. **Unity** | ____ | **C** Differences in colour, size, shape or weight that make items stand out. |

### 5 Explain what is meant by ‘Depth’. (2 marks)

### 6 Explain what is meant by ‘Alignment’. (2 marks)

**Check and reflect**
Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?